

Day 94 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Economy & TN Dev. Admin. (7): India's 2026 Semiconductor Plant Inaugurations

READING MATERIAL

Covers 4 major 2026 milestones in India's semiconductor manufacturing buildout, all under the India Semiconductor Mission framework.

Q: What did Micron Technology inaugurate on 28 February 2026, and where?

A: India's first semiconductor Assembly, Test, and Packaging (ATMP) facility, at Sanand, Gujarat — a ~\$2.75 billion investment converting DRAM/NAND wafers from Micron's global network into finished memory/storage products.

Q: What did Kaynes Semicon inaugurate on 31 March 2026, also at Sanand, and what is its capacity?

A: An OSAT (Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test) facility, focused on chip testing and packaging — investment of ₹33 billion (~\$347.9 million), with a production capacity of around 6 million chips per day.

Q: Which state entered India's semiconductor manufacturing ecosystem for the first time on 15 May 2026, and under which scheme?

A: Rajasthan — with its first semiconductor ATMP/OSAT facility at Bhiwadi, developed under the central government's SPECS (Scheme for Promotion of Manufacturing of Electronic Components and Semiconductors) scheme.

Q: What major front-end fabrication agreement was signed on 16 May 2026, and what does it involve?

A: Tata Electronics signed a strategic agreement with Netherlands-based ASML to support India's first front-end semiconductor fabrication facility — a 300mm wafer fab being developed at Dholera, Gujarat, backed by an estimated \$11 billion investment; ASML will supply advanced manufacturing technology and equipment.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Micron Technology's ATMP facility — India's first such facility — is located at:

- A. Dholera, Gujarat
- B. Sanand, Gujarat ✓**
- C. Bhiwadi, Rajasthan
- D. Bengaluru, Karnataka

Explanation: Sanand, Gujarat (inaugurated 28 Feb 2026). [medium, web-research]

2. Kaynes Semicon's OSAT facility (inaugurated 31 March 2026) has a production capacity of approximately:

- A. 1 million chips/day
- B. 3 million chips/day
- C. 6 million chips/day ✓**
- D. 10 million chips/day

Explanation: 6 million chips per day. [hard, web-research]

3. Rajasthan's first semiconductor facility (Bhiwadi, inaugurated 15 May 2026) was developed under which scheme?

- A. PLI Scheme
- B. SPECS Scheme ✓**
- C. Make in India 2.0
- D. Startup India

Explanation: SPECS Scheme. [hard, web-research]

4. Tata Electronics signed a strategic agreement with which company (16 May 2026) for India's first front-end semiconductor fab?

- A. TSMC
- B. ASML ✓**
- C. Samsung
- D. Intel

Explanation: ASML (Netherlands). [medium, web-research]

5. Tata Electronics' front-end semiconductor fab (with ASML) is being developed at Dholera, Gujarat, with an estimated investment of:

A. \$5 billion

B. \$8 billion

C. \$11 billion ✓

D. \$15 billion

Explanation: \$11 billion. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Visual Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Visual Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills, testing image-based logic rather than text/number puzzles — mirror images, water images, and embedded figures are the standard formats. Note: TNPSC's own answer key has at least one acknowledged disputed mirror-image question, a useful reminder that on visual questions specifically, double-check your own reasoning rather than assuming the 'obvious' answer is automatically right.

Q: What is the rule for a MIRROR image, and what stays the same vs. flips?

A: A mirror image flips LEFT and RIGHT (the right side of the object appears on the left, and vice versa), while TOP and BOTTOM stay the same. Imagine holding the figure up to a vertical mirror.

Q: What is the rule for a WATER image, and how is it different from a mirror image?

A: A water image flips TOP and BOTTOM (it appears upside-down, as if reflected in still water below the object), while LEFT and RIGHT stay the same. This is the opposite axis of flipping compared to a mirror image.

Q: What is the best strategy for solving mirror/water image questions quickly?

A: Focus on the most unique or asymmetric part of the figure first (not the symmetric parts, which look the same either way) — mentally flip just that distinctive part along the correct axis (vertical line for mirror, horizontal line for water), and use it to eliminate options before checking the rest.

Q: What is an 'embedded figure' question, and what does it test?

A: A question where a simple shape is hidden within a more complex, cluttered figure, and you must identify which of the answer-choice shapes appears embedded within it. Tests visual scanning and pattern-matching rather than flipping/rotation.

Q: Real exam (flagged as disputed by TNPSC itself): A figure is shown, and you must choose its correct mirror image from 4 options.

What's the most reliable way to verify your choice, given that even the official answer key has had disputed cases here?

A: Don't just eyeball it — explicitly trace which side each distinctive feature should land on after a left-right flip, point by point, rather than relying on a quick visual impression. Given that TNPSC's own committee has had to review at least one mirror-image answer, treat your worked-through reasoning as more trustworthy than a snap visual judgment, and double-check rather than rushing.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In a MIRROR image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom
- B. Left and right ✓**
- C. Diagonal corners only
- D. Nothing swaps

Explanation: Left and right swap; top and bottom stay the same. [easy, web-research]

2. In a WATER image of a figure, which pair of sides swap?

- A. Top and bottom ✓**
- B. Left and right
- C. Both pairs swap
- D. Neither swaps

Explanation: Top and bottom swap; left and right stay the same. [easy, web-research]

3. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its mirror image (left-right flip)?

- A. b
- B. d ✓**
- C. p
- D. q

Explanation: 'b' has its stem on the left with the bowl attached at bottom-right. Flipping left-right moves the stem to the right with the bowl at bottom-left — that's the letter 'd'. [medium, authored]

4. The letter 'b' would appear as which letter in its water image (top-bottom flip)?

- A. b
- B. d

C. p ✓

D. q

Explanation: Flipping 'b' top-to-bottom keeps the stem on the left but moves the bowl from bottom-right to top-right — that's the letter 'p'. (Mirror and water images of the same letter generally differ — here mirror gives 'd', water gives 'p'.) [hard, authored]

5. An 'embedded figure' question primarily tests:

A. Arithmetic ability

B. Visual scanning and pattern-matching within a cluttered figure ✓

C. Vocabulary

D. Memory of a list

Explanation: Visual scanning/pattern-matching to find a hidden shape within a complex figure. [medium, web-research]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" — Robert Frost

READING MATERIAL

One of Robert Frost's most famous poems — a traveller pauses by snowy woods, tempted to linger, before reminding himself of obligations still ahead. Real exam evidence already confirms the poem's most quoted line is tested directly; literary analysis sources fill in the structural details (rhyme scheme, personification, repetition) that 'appreciation' questions typically probe.

Q: Real exam: "The woods are lovely, dark and deep, / But I have promises to keep." Who wrote this, and what's the poem?

A: Robert Frost, from "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" — confirmed via a real TNPSC question (2024) asking exactly this attribution.

Q: What is the poem's distinctive rhyme scheme, and how does it change in the final stanza?

A: The first three stanzas follow an AABA pattern where each stanza's unrhymed third line seeds the NEXT stanza's dominant rhyme (e.g., 'here' in stanza 1 becomes the rhyme sound driving stanza 2). The final stanza breaks this chain: instead of introducing a new sound to drive a further stanza, all four lines rhyme together (DDDD: deep/keep/sleep/sleep) — formally mirroring the poem's sense of finally coming to rest.

Q: How is the horse personified in the poem?

A: The horse is described as thinking the stop is 'queer' and giving its harness bells a shake, as if asking 'is there some mistake?' — giving the animal human-like reasoning/curiosity, set against the speaker's own quiet, almost trance-like pause.

Q: What does the famous repeated final line, "And miles to go before I sleep," suggest?

A: On its surface, the literal road/journey still ahead — but the doubled repetition invites a deeper reading about ongoing duties/responsibilities (and some readers extend 'sleep' toward mortality, though Frost himself resisted that specific equation).

Q: How are the trees described, and what figure of speech is that?

A: "Lovely, dark and deep" — personification-adjacent imagery that makes the woods feel alluring almost like a living invitation to linger, heightening the pull between staying and the duty to move on.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The woods are lovely, dark and deep, but I have promises to keep" was written by:

- A. Sarojini Naidu
- B. John Masefield
- C. Robert Frost ✓**
- D. William Henry Davies

Explanation: Robert Frost — confirmed via a real 2024 TNPSC question. [easy, question-bank-2024]

2. The final stanza of "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" breaks from the earlier AABA pattern by using which rhyme scheme?

- A. ABAB
- B. AABB
- C. DDDD (all four lines rhyme) ✓**
- D. No rhyme at all

Explanation: DDDD — deep/keep/sleep/sleep, all four lines share the same end-rhyme. [hard, web-research]

3. How is the horse personified in the poem?

- A. It speaks aloud to the traveller
- B. It thinks the stop is 'queer' and shakes its bells as if questioning it ✓**
- C. It refuses to move at all
- D. It gallops away in fear

Explanation: The horse is given human-like curiosity/reasoning about the unusual stop. [medium, web-research]

4. The poem's final line, "And miles to go before I sleep," is repeated. What does this repetition emphasize?

- A. The traveller is lost
- B. Ongoing duties/responsibilities still ahead ✓**
- C. The journey has ended

D. A change of destination

Explanation: Emphasizes the obligations still pulling the speaker onward, despite the temptation to linger. [medium, web-research]

5. In the first three stanzas, how does Frost's rhyme scheme connect one stanza to the next?

A. Each stanza's unrhymed third line becomes the next stanza's dominant rhyme sound ✓

B. Every stanza repeats the exact same four rhymes

C. There is no connection between stanzas

D. Each stanza rhymes with the title only

Explanation: The AABA pattern's unrhymed third line seeds the following stanza's rhyme sound. [hard, web-research]